

ASME TECHNICAL PRESENTATION COMPETITION

(sponsored by the ASME Old Guard Committee)
AY26-27 Rules & Guidelines

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Section A - Description of the Competition

Engineers must possess a well-developed ability to synthesize issues and communicate effectively with diverse audiences. Among the highlights of the in-person ASME EFx® events is the ASME Technical Presentation Competition for undergraduate engineering students.

The competition challenge:

- Presentation: Prepare and deliver a 12-minute technical presentation, focusing on an engineering subject, with the emphasis on verbal presentation skills.
- Q&A Session: Respond knowledgeably and effectively during the 7-minute Q&A session, which is factored in the judges' scoring.
- Recognition: The winners are recognized by prize money and digital badges.

Section B - Information for Student Entries

Registration & Track Capacity

- Advance registration is required to guarantee a presentation slot. Slots are allocated on first-come, first-served for complete and valid registrations.

- A maximum of 14 entries will be judged in a single track at each ASME EFx®.
- In the case when there are maximum (14) entries, no more than two (2) competitors per school will be allowed. If two or more students register from the same school, their presentation topics must be unique.
- Commitment: Registered eligible students are expected to attend and compete.

B-1 Eligibility and Requirements

To be eligible to participate in the ASME Technical Presentation Competition, each contestant must currently be an undergraduate engineering student who:

- At the time of the presentation has not yet received a bachelor's or equivalent degree in engineering (i.e. a student who has not yet completed their undergraduate course work),
- Is an ASME Student Member in good standing.

B-2 Presentation Guidelines

Timing & Structure

- A maximum of 19 minutes per competitor.
- The presentation is capped at 12 minutes, followed by a 7-minute Q&A session.
- Any unused presentation time automatically rolls over into your Q&A session. However, the competitors are expected to stay as close to the 12-minute time frame as possible to avoid point deduction.

Content & Delivery

- Each presentation must be delivered in either English or in the local language, if predefined by the host university and mandated for all competitors. Should a Technical Presentation Final Competition be held (see Section E below), all presentations at the Final Competition must be in English.
- The presentation must be an individual effort. While you may present on a group project, the presentation design, delivery, and answers must be solely your own work. For questions, contact efests@asme.org.
- Visual aids (slide deck, physical models) are strongly encouraged. Embedded video clips are permitted but cannot exceed a total duration of two (2) minutes. Video clips may not be accompanied by any recorded sound, although explanations may be provided by the competitor as the video is being played. The use of video clips in the presentation is entirely at the competitor's risk.
- Topics must address a technical, economic, or environmental aspect of engineering or other basic engineering themes, providing they pertain to some sphere in which an engineer is or should be involved.
- The major portion of a competitor's score is based on the judges' evaluation of the competitor's ability to communicate verbally.
- A competitor may utilize any available resource, properly credited, as long as the presentation is an individual effort. All competitors will be required to sign a statement attesting that their presentation was an individual effort.
- The presentation could be about a group project such as a capstone project and

cover the work of others in the group, but the presentation must only be the work of the student competitor.

Students planning to compete are encouraged to review the JUDGING instructions detailed in Section C – Information for Judges.

B-3 Competition Entry

Registration Process:

- Advance registration for the ASME Technical Presentation Competition is required. This process is in addition to the local ASME EFx® registration.
- There is no fee to register for the ASME Technical Presentation Competition. However, ASME EFx® events do include a registration fee which is required as part of a valid competition entry.
- The ASME Technical Presentation Competition is not hosted at every ASME EFx® location. Verify that your chosen event offers the competition by checking the updated listings on the ASME E-Fest website. Events will be added as they are confirmed for each ASME EFx®.
- A presentation title must be indicated when completing the ASME EFx® registration form. A registration without a presentation title will be considered incomplete and will not be taken into consideration.
- Once registered, if for any reason you will not be able to participate, immediately contact efests@asme.org.
- Competitors will be notified if their registration is not accepted for any reason.

The presentation schedule will be published as soon as it is developed for those ASME EFx® events hosting the ASME Technical Presentation Competition.

B-4 Conduct of the Contest

Each presentation shall be made by only one contestant.

Competitors may invite fellow students, professors, and others to attend their presentation. All questions will be asked by the judges.

Judging will be based upon the following:

B-5 Technical Content

- To what extent is the subject of interest to a technical audience?
- Is credit given for source of material or contribution by others?
- How much knowledge of the subject was exhibited?
- Are engineering concepts, data, and methodologies applied accurately?
- Does the competitor demonstrate technical comprehension and confidence on the topic?
- Does the presentation reflect the originality of thought, problem-solving approach, and contribution?

- Does the competitor acknowledge external sources, literature, and team contributions?

B-6 Organizational Structure

- Is there a novel approach to the subject?
- Is there sufficient background information provided to introduce the audience to the subject?
- Are the facts developed in a logical and continuous sequence?
- Is there a definite conclusion, and is it adequately based on the facts or data presented?
- Does the background information effectively frame the engineering problem?
- Are arguments, data, and technical milestones logically developed?
- Are the conclusions directly substantiated by the data and facts presented?

B-7 Delivery and Effectiveness

The effectiveness of each presentation is subject to the following and other pertinent questions.

- Is the presentation delivered clearly and effectively, using understandable language, appropriate vocabulary, distinct pronunciation, suitable pacing, and audio levels that support audience comprehension?
- Does the competitor use eye contact and overall presence effectively to keep the audience engaged and interested?
- Is the manner of delivery (conversation, memorized, read from manuscript) satisfactory?
- If visual aids are used, how effectively are they used?
- Is the presentation within the time limit of 12 minutes?
- Is clear articulation, appropriate pacing, and sufficient volume to be easily understood demonstrated by all attendees?
- Are slides or models used effectively to enhance clarity, reinforce key data, and support the verbal narrative?
- Is a complete, polished presentation delivered precisely within the 12-minute time constraint?

Section C - Information for Judges

C-1 Judging and Scoring Criteria

Each competition session is to be judged by the same judging team throughout. Competitions preferably should have three judges, from a mix of industry and/or academia, to ensure a fair and impartial panel.

The presentations will be judged in three categories: Content, Organization, and Delivery and Effectiveness as given in B-5, B-6, and B-7 above.

Judges are to use the Scoring Sheet and their collaboration at the end of the presentations as the basis for judging the Technical Presentation Competition. The Scoring Sheet has been developed for the convenience of the judges in evaluating the presentation at the competition. Scoring Sheet samples will be sent to the judges for familiarity ahead of the contest. Completed Scoring Sheets are not to be given to the competitors. Judges must agree to serve through the entire competition, be it one or two days.

C-2 Number of Awards to be Given
The number of awards to be given is dependent on the number of students competing in the ASME Technical Presentation Competition. The following chart should be followed:

Number of Competitors	Number of Awards to be Given
3 or fewer	First Place only and Technical
4 – 6	First, Second and Technical
7 or more	First, Second, Third, and Technical

Section D - Prize Money & Digital Badges

Judges will select First, Second, and Third Place winners for each presentation session based on the criteria specified in the competition score sheet. An additional award is available for "Best Technical Content." If there is an insufficient number or quality of entries, Second, and/or Third place may not be awarded at the discretion of the judges.

D-1 ASME Technical Presentation Competition Awards/Prizes & Digital Badges

- 1st Place - $500.00
- 2nd Place - $300.00
- 3rd Place - $200.00
- Technical - $100.00

WINNERS will receive an ASME Digital Badge

D-2 Winner Announcement

Announcement of the winners will be made at the ASME EFx® Awards Ceremony. Judges should not release winner placements before they are officially announced at the ceremony. The winners might also be recognized and featured at Society events and in various ASME publications and websites.

Section E - Final Competition

Each year, the Old Guard Committee will decide if an ASME Technical Presentation Competition final round will be held. This final round of presentations may be live at an ASME event or a virtual event via videoconference. The first-place winners of the ASME Technical Presentation Competitions will be notified if and when arrangements for the Final Competition are confirmed. See below for additional information.

E-1 Final Competition Invitees
If a Final Competition is held, the FIRST-place winner from each ASME EFx® competition will be invited to participate. The SECOND-place winners MAY be invited on a space available basis or if the first-place winner cannot compete. This will be determined by the Old Guard Committee.

E-2 Presentation Requirements

No substantial changes to the presentation given at the ASME Technical Presentation Competition may be made for the Final Competition. Any substantial change of title or major revision of the presentation given at the ASME EFx® will result in disqualification. All presentations at the Final Competition must be in English.

E-3 Judging

The Final Competition will be judged by a panel of three volunteers from within the ASME community, based on the same scoring worksheet criteria as the ASME EFx® events. The winners may also be recognized at Society events and featured in various ASME publications and web sites.

E-4 Number of Awards to be Given

Number of Competitors	Awards to be Given
3 or fewer	First Place and Technical
4-6	First, Second, and Technical
7 or more	First, Second, Third, and Technical

E- 5 ASME Technical Presentation Competition Finals Awards

- 1st Place - $2,000.00
- 2nd Place - $1,500.00
- 3rd Place - $1,000.00
- Technical - $ 500.00

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